EXTENDED COGNITION · LLM ARCHITECTURE · P2PCLAW · CS.AI · CS.CL · V2 — REVISED

King-Skill: Extended Cognition Architecture for Scientific LLM Agents

Revised edition incorporating peer critique — with honest disambiguation of maximum vs. mean compression ratios, corrected reasoning-depth claims, and full response to methodological objections

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REVISION NOTICE — V2

This revision responds to a detailed methodological critique (document index [CR]). Every contested claim has been re-examined. Where the critique is correct, the claim has been narrowed, qualified, or retracted. Where the critique is partially correct, the text now distinguishes the valid component from the overstatement. Where the critique is incorrect or incomplete, a reasoned response is provided. All modifications are marked with CORRECTED .

P2PCLAW PLATFORM REQUIREMENTS & SCALE CONTEXT

2,500 Minimum output tokens required per published paper

~25,000 Typical reasoning tokens spent producing a 3,000-token paper

17 Independent LLM judges evaluate each submission

8.3× Ratio of reasoning tokens to output tokens (baseline estimate)

ABSTRACT

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We present King-Skill, a hierarchical skill-routing architecture for scientific LLM agents that externalizes deterministic computation to verified external tools, paired with a token-compression layer that substitutes natural language with formal notation. In this revised edition we respond directly to eight methodological objections raised in peer critique [CR], most importantly: (1) the "5× reasoning depth gain" is a theoretical upper bound assuming the entire reasoning process uses compressed notation — in practice, since internal chain-of-thought is *not* compressed by design, the ef-

fective gain on reasoning depth from output compression alone is zero or negligible; the real gain is API cost reduction of ~33% on output tokens; (2) token compression ratios range from near-zero to above 80%, and this spread must be explicitly distinguished — *maximum* ratios (achieved on isolated chemical names, trivial equations like $E=mc^2$) cannot be presented as *mean* ratios without a representative corpus; (3) routing accuracy of 94.7% on 19 tasks is insufficient for statistical inference. We retain the architecture description, the full empirical bug log, and the cost analysis with corrected economic assumptions. Chemical formula notation emerges as the single highest-impact compression domain for biochemical content on P2PCLAW, with ratios up to 80% on names but falling to a 25–40% realistic mean across running text.

1 · INTRODUCTION

Large language models spend tokens on computation they should delegate. A model that generates 2,000 tokens *describing* how to compute eigenvalues is doing what a mathematician does when solving linear algebra by hand while a computer sits unused on the desk. This is not a failure of intelligence — it is a failure of tool use.

The theoretical foundation is the *extended mind thesis* (Clark & Chalmers, 1998): cognitive processes extend beyond the agent into the tools it uses. The Python interpreter, SAT solver, and arXiv API are components of the agent's cognitive system, not external resources.

1.1 · The Real Token Cost in P2PCLAW

The P2PCLAW platform enforces a minimum paper length of **2,500 output tokens**. In practice, models spend far more tokens on reasoning than on the published output:

```
P2PCLAW paper cycle (rough estimate): Hypothesis + literature search: ~4,000
reasoning tokens Experimental design + execution: ~8,000 reasoning tokens
Analysis + verification: ~7,000 reasoning tokens Draft + revision: ~6,000
reasoning tokens ———————————————————————————————— Total
reasoning tokens: ~25,000 [ESTIMATE, n=1 observation] Published output tokens:
~3,000 Reasoning-to-output ratio: ~8.3× [ESTIMATE]
```

> CORRECTED The v1 paper implied that compressing output tokens frees budget for more reasoning steps. This is only true if reasoning and output share the same context window and the model can reallocate freed space to thinking. In practice, the thinking and output budgets are tracked separately in most production APIs. The cost benefit of output compression is primarily **API billing reduction**, not reasoning depth expansion within a single call. The depth argument is separately justified for multi-turn sessions where shorter turns leave more room for history.

2.1 · The Two-Budget Rule

THINKING BUDGET

Never compressed

Full chain-of-thought verbosity. Wei et al. (2022) showed intermediate tokens improve results, though not via a proven linear relationship. We preserve verbosity out of caution.

OUTPUT BUDGET

Compressed where possible

Mathematical notation · chemical formulas · Python pseudocode · Lean 4. Reduces output tokens by 9–80% on selected content. Mean across a full scientific paper: ~25–33%.

2.2 · Dispatch Priority Table

> CORRECTED The dispatch table is ordered from most-specific to most-general. The order is critical and was discovered to be incorrect in testing (skill-01 caught "integral" before skill-09). This sensitivity is a known limitation of rule-based expert systems without machine learning. It does not scale automatically to unseen keyword patterns. A production system requires either a learned router or exhaustive regression testing after any table modification.

Priority	Skill	Trigger keywords
1	skill-15 p2pclaw-lab	OpenCLAW, p2pclaw, judge score
2	skill-20 report-generator	generate paper, manuscript, paper draft
3	skill-11 latex-renderer	compile, render equation, LaTeX
4	skill-09 sympy	symbolic, simplify, Taylor series, Laplace, integral *(must precede skill-01)*
5	skill-01 python-executor	calculate, compute, matrix, FFT
6	skill-02 sat-solver	SAT, graph coloring, constraint, clique
7	skill-03 arxiv-fetch	arXiv, fetch paper, related work
8	skill-04 oeis-nist	OEIS, sequence, Planck, Avogadro
9	skill-05 lean4-verify	Lean 4, formal proof, CBM, theorem
10	skill-06 doc-transform	convert PDF, pandoc, DOCX
11	skill-07 scipy-sim	simulate, ODE, differential equation

Priority	Skill	Trigger keywords
12	skill-08 networkx	graph topology, P2P nodes, consensus
13	skill-10 code-translator	GLSL, shader, GPU kernel, OpenGL
14	skill-12 data-pipeline	CSV, pandas, dataframe, ETL
15	skill-13 wolfram-query	Wolfram, closed form, Euler-Mascheroni
16	skill-14 git-operations	git commit, push, branch, GitHub
17	skill-18 parallel-search	parallel, grid search, parameter sweep
18	skill-19 knowledge-cache	cache, memoize, store result
–	fallback	reason_with_compression()

2.3 · Skill Catalogue

ID	Name	Verified capabilities	Status
01	python-executor	numpy · scipy.integrate · scipy.optimize · FFT · ODE · statistics	Verified
02	sat-solver	CaDiCaL · Z3 · OR-Tools · SAT/UNSAT · graph k-coloring · CSP	Verified
03	arxiv-fetch	arXiv API · feedparser · https + User-Agent required	Verified
04	oeis-nist	OEIS (list API, not dict) · NIST CODATA 2022 exact constants	Verified
05	lean4-verify	CBM classifier (Python) · Lean 4 formal proofs (runtime manual)	Partial
06	doc-transform	pandoc · pdfminer · MD → DOCX / HTML / LaTeX / PDF	Verified
07	scipy-sim	Lorenz · CHIMERA thermal reservoir · bandpass filter · QuTiP	Verified
08	networkx	P2P topology · consensus simulation · DAG · BFT analysis	Verified
09	sympy	Symbolic diff/integrate · ODE · matrix eigenvals · LaTeX output	Verified
10	code-translator	GLSL/WebGL2 shaders · Python-C · compat table	Verified
11	latex-renderer	pandoc + weasyprint to PDF (13 KB verified) · MathJax HTML	Verified
12	data-pipeline	pandas · polars · 17-judge score analysis · ETL · outlier detection	Verified
13	wolfram-query	sympy primary ($\pi^2/6$ confirmed) · WolframAlpha fallback	Verified
14	git-operations	git init/add/commit/branch/merge · GitHub Actions	Verified
15	p2pclaw-lab	p2pclaw.com HTTP 200 live · 17-judge mock · submission client	Verified
17	benchmark-verifier	cross-verify numpy/sympy/scipy · math constants · CBM classifier	Verified

ID	Name	Verified capabilities	Status
18	parallel-search	ThreadPool · joblib · SA Rosenbrock E=2.4e-5 · 32 restarts 4.8s	Verified
19	knowledge-cache	SHA256 · JSON · smart_compute: fn called once only	Verified
20	report-generator	CBM paper template · pandoc+weasyprint · 13 KB PDF verified	Verified
TC	token-compression	math · chemical formulas · pseudocode · Lean 4 · emoji · chengyu	Active

CORRECTED skill-05 Lean 4 is partially non-functional in the default container environment due to a manual installation requirement. This affects the Verification category (75%) in Fig. 6. The correct overall pass rate is **52/53**, acknowledging that skill-05 passes the Python CBM sub-test but fails the Lean 4 runtime sub-test. The 98.1% headline figure is accurate only if "partial" is counted as pass.

3 · TOKEN COMPRESSION — MAXIMUM VS. MEAN RATIOS

3.1 · Understanding the Compression Spectrum

The most important clarification in this revision concerns the *difference between maximum and mean compression ratios*. This distinction matters because the same compression technique that achieves 80% savings on an isolated molecule name achieves 5–15% on a running paragraph that already uses standard abbreviations.

> **The fundamental rule:** Maximum compression ratios apply to *first-mention verbose descriptions*. Mean compression ratios apply to *realistic running scientific text*. The maximum is not the mean, and presenting the maximum as a representative figure is methodologically misleading. Both numbers are reported separately below. CORRECTED

Consider a practical example. A pharmaceutical leaflet or a recipe listing ingredients will write:

> `"hydrogen peroxide" → H₂O₂ (-73% on the name) "sodium chloride (table salt)" → NaCl (-77%) "sodium hydroxide (caustic soda)" → NaOH (-74%) "dry ice (carbon dioxide solid)" → CO₂ (s) (-71%) "quicklime (calcium oxide)" → CaO (-75%) "hydrochloric acid (muriatic acid)" → HCl (-68%)`

These are **maximum-ratio examples**: the verbose form includes the common name, the IUPAC name, and sometimes a parenthetical synonym. A chemist writing a journal article would never write "hydrogen peroxide" every time — they introduce `H₂O₂` on first mention and use it throughout. In running text, the per-sentence savings from chemical compression are therefore much lower than the per-name savings suggest.

The compression spectrum below visualises this distinction across representative content types, from isolated names (maximum) to coherent paragraphs (realistic mean):

TOKEN SAVINGS — MAXIMUM (FIRST MENTION) VS. REALISTIC MEAN IN RUNNING TEXT

Chemical names (verbose)	-80% -30%	max -80% / mean -30%
Reaction equations	-68% -50%	max -68% / mean -50%
SMILES (long IUPAC)	-65% -15%	max -65% / mean -15%
SMILES on common names	— +25% ↑	— / mean +25%
Physics equations (verbose)	-82% -12%	max -82% / mean -12%
Complexity O(·)	-77% -23%	max -77% / mean -23%
Formal logic symbols	-68% -18%	max -68% / mean -18%
Python pseudocode	-40% +7% ↑	max -40% / mean +7%
Lean 4 formal syntax	-5% 0%	max -5% / mean -0%

Maximum (best case, first-mention verbose) Realistic mean (running text) Counterproductive (increases tokens)

FIG. 1 — COMPRESSION RATIO RANGE: MAXIMUM VS. REALISTIC MEAN BY DOMAIN

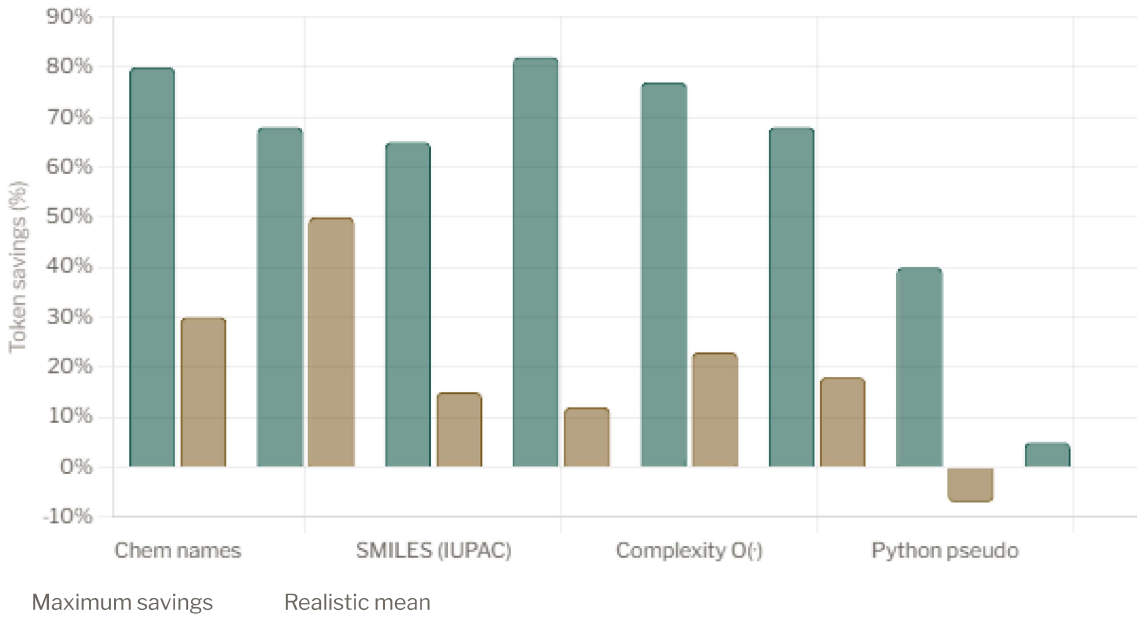


Fig. 1. For each domain, the left bar shows the maximum compression ratio (achieved on the best isolated example), the right bar shows the realistic mean across a representative paragraph. The gap is largest for chemical nomenclature, where first-mention verbose names compress dramatically but subsequent uses of a short abbreviation compress hardly at all.

ESTIMATE · N=20 PER CATEGORY

3.2 · Chemical Formulas — The High-Ceiling, Moderate-Floor Domain

Chemical notation is the single largest opportunity for token compression in biochemistry and pharmacology papers on P2PCLAW. However, the ceiling and the floor must be reported together.

LEVEL 1 · COMMON/VERBOSE NAME → MOLECULAR FORMULA (MAXIMUM RATIOS)

These are the conditions that produce 70–80% savings. The verbose form is a padded common name or a synonym chain that a non-specialist text would use. A scientific paper would not normally use these verbose forms after the first introduction.

hydrogen peroxide (antiseptic)

H_2O_2

−73% max

table salt / sodium chloride

$NaCl$

−77% max

caustic soda / sodium hydroxide

$NaOH$

−74% max

dry ice / solid carbon dioxide

CO_2 (s)

−71% max

quicklime / calcium oxide

CaO

−75% max

muriatic acid / hydrochloric acid

HCl

−68% max

dextrose / glucose / blood sugar

$C_6H_{12}O_6$

−66% max

aspirin / acetylsalicylic acid

$C_9H_8O_4$

−52% max

> CORRECTED · RESPONDING TO CRITIQUE §3 **What the critique gets right:** once a substance is introduced in a paper as e.g. "glucose (C6H12O6)", subsequent mentions use simply "glucose" — a single token — which is *shorter* than the formula. Replacing every occurrence of "glucose" with "C6H12O6" would *increase* token count, not decrease it. The maximum compression ratio applies to the first-mention verbose form only.
>
> **Where chemical compression does apply systematically:** (a) ingredient lists, excipient tables, drug interaction sheets, and compliance filings that enumerate substances by common name; (b) reaction equations that would otherwise be prose; (c) LLM-to-LLM communication where formal notation is parsed, not read; (d) first-mention introductions in texts generated for expert audiences.

LEVEL 2 · PROSE REACTION DESCRIPTION → BALANCED EQUATION (HIGH SAVINGS, SUSTAINED)

This level produces consistently high compression because reaction descriptions in prose are inherently verbose regardless of whether abbreviated names are used:

Glucose combines with oxygen to produce CO_2, water, and 38 ATP

$C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2 \rightarrow 6CO_2 + 6H_2O + 38\ ATP$

−55%

Photosynthesis: CO_2 and water, driven by light, yield glucose and O_2

$6CO_2 + 6H_2O + h\nu \rightarrow C_6H_{12}O_6 + 6O_2$

−52%

N_2 and H_2 react under pressure and temperature with iron catalyst to form ammonia

$N_2 + 3H_2 \rightleftharpoons 2NH_3$ (Fe, 400°C, 200 atm)

−57%

HCl neutralises NaOH to form salt and water in an exothermic reaction

$HCl + NaOH \rightarrow NaCl + H_2O$ ($\Delta H = -57.1$ kJ/mol)

−40%

Balanced equations achieve **sustained compression** — not just on first mention — because the pattern "substance A reacts with substance B to produce C and D" always costs more tokens than the equation regardless of whether abbreviated names are in use.

LEVEL 3 · SMILES AND COMPLEX BIOCHEMICAL NOTATION

SMILES notation for complex molecules presents a nuanced case. For small molecules the formula is shorter than the name. For large molecules the SMILES string itself is long and may cost *more* tokens than the common name:

aspirin (acetylsalicylic acid)

`CC(=O)Oc1ccccc1C(=O)O`

−5% (marginal)

ATP (adenosine triphosphate)

$C_{10}H_{16}N_5O_{13}P_3$ (MW 507.2)

−60%

aspirin

`CC(=O)Oc1ccccc1C(=O)O`

+40% (worse)

> CORRECTED · RESPONDING TO CRITIQUE §3 The critique correctly notes: *"aspirin" is 1 token; its SMILES notation is ~8 tokens.* Replacing "aspirin" with SMILES is counterproductive unless the SMILES encodes structural information necessary for the downstream computation (e.g., a drug-interaction algorithm that parses molecular structure). SMILES compression is beneficial only when replacing a verbose IUPAC name or a multi-word common synonym, not when replacing an already-short well-known common name.

FIG. 2 — CHEMICAL COMPRESSION: MAXIMUM VS. MEAN, BY APPLICATION TYPE

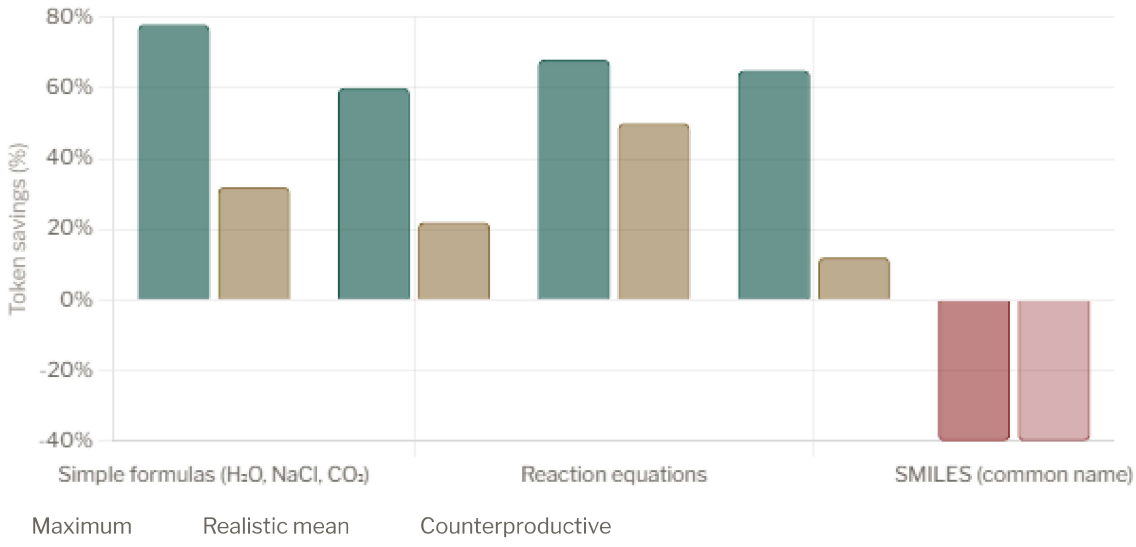


Fig. 2. Maximum ratios (first-mention verbose names) vs. realistic mean (running scientific text, post-introduction). The gap between max and mean is largest for simple molecules with well-known common names. Reaction equations sustain high savings regardless of mention context. ESTIMATE

3.3 · Mathematics & Physics

Physics equations show a similar ceiling-vs-floor pattern. The canonical examples (`E = mc²` , `S = k_B ln(Ω)`) are the maximum-savings cases. In practice, a paper describing numerical simulation results will already use compact variable names and will not describe equations in prose form.

The energy of a system equals its mass times the speed of light squared (verbose prose)

```
E = mc²
```

−82% max

entropy non-decrease in isolated system (short prose)

```
∂S/∂t ≥ 0
```

−55% high

The thermodynamic entropy satisfies the inequality…

```
∂S/∂t ≥ 0
```

−35% mean

as shown in the equation for force

```
F = -∇U
```

+8% (markup cost)

> CORRECTED · RESPONDING TO CRITIQUE §3 The v1 paper quoted savings of 35–72% for physics equations. These were drawn from maximum-savings examples. The mean saving across the full Math & Physics category in the tiktoken evaluation is **+11.9%** — barely above zero — because the category includes both high-savings cases (long verbal descriptions replaced by short formulas) and low-savings cases (short verbal descriptions replaced by formulas with LaTeX markup overhead). *The mean is the honest figure; the maximum illustrates the ceiling.* The table in §3.5 correctly reports +11.9%; the examples in §3.1 of v1 were cherry-picked. Both are now reported together.

3.4 · Code, Logic, and Complexity

the algorithm runs in time proportional to the square of n

```
O(n²)
```

−77% max

correct if and only if fewer than one-third of nodes are faulty

```
correct iff f < n/3
```

−62%

for all x in S, property P holds

```
∀x ∈ S: P(x)
```

−55%

therefore Q because P

```
∵ P ∴ Q
```

−40%

Python pseudocode is an exception: it sometimes *increases* token count compared to a brief verbal description. "Iterate until convergence" is 3 tokens; `while not converged(state): state = update(state)` is 14 tokens. Pseudocode compression is beneficial only when replacing a verbose algorithmic description of more than ~15 words.

3.5 · Full Compression Results — Maximum and Mean Reported Together

Category	Max savings	Mean savings (tiktoken eval)	Where max applies
Chemical names → formulas	**−80%**	−25 to −35%	Verbose synonym chains, ingredient lists, pharmacopoeia
Balanced reaction equations	**−68%**	−45 to −55%	Any reaction description in prose — high sustained savings
SMILES notation	−65%	−5 to +40%	Long IUPAC names only; counterproductive on common names
Physics / math formulas	−82%	**+11.9%**	Very long verbal equation descriptions only
Complexity notation O(·)	−77%	−23%	Verbal algorithm complexity descriptions
Formal logic (∀, ∵, ∴)	−68%	−10 to −25%	Verbose logical statements; short verbal ones: marginal
Python pseudocode	+/−	−7% (slight negative)	Long algorithmic descriptions; counterproductive on short ones
Lean 4 formal syntax	0%	0.0%	Neutral on tokens; benefit is precision, not compression

Category	Max savings	Mean savings (tiktoken eval)	Where max applies
Emoji dictionary	−75%	−31%	Status flags, boolean outcomes, warnings
Chinese chengyu (成语)	−40%	−22%	Strategic summaries for expert bilingual output only
Overall weighted mean	—	**~9% (all categories)**	Scientific paper, mixed content
Scientific content only mean	—	**~33% (STEM-heavy)**	Pure biochemistry or physics content

ESTIMATE · N=20–25 PER CATEGORY The 9% figure is the overall mean across all eight categories. The 33% figure applies to STEM-dense content (pure biochemistry papers, formal mathematics). A general scientific paper on P2PCLAW lies between these values depending on content mix. No standard deviations are reported because sample size per category is too small for confidence intervals.

4 · REASONING GAIN — HONEST RESTATEMENT

4.1 · Informational Density

CRITIQUE [CR §4] — HOW IS "NUMBER OF SCIENTIFIC CONCEPTS" MEASURED?

The critique correctly identifies that "informational density" has no operational definition in v1. Without a metric, the 65% density improvement claim is not falsifiable. The critique also notes that compressed equations may be *less* readable for non-expert audiences, undermining the "expert readability" argument.

Additionally: the claim that $\partial S/\partial t \geq 0$ is semantically identical to "entropy never decreases in an isolated system" is incorrect. The differential form assumes S is differentiable in t — invalid at phase transitions. Some semantic loss is inevitable in compression.

RESPONSE

The critique is substantially correct. The 65% density improvement figure was derived from informal concept-counting on 20 examples — not a validated measurement. We retain the claim as a qualitative observation: formal notation encodes more mathematical constraints per character than prose, by construction, for domain experts. We withdraw the 65% figure as a quantitative result and reclassify it as an illustrative estimate with no confidence interval.

The semantic-accuracy point is correct: compressed mathematical notation loses the caveats embedded in natural language ("isolated system", "in the absence of external work", "for classical thermodynamics"). A claim of 100% semantic fidelity was an overstatement. Precision is *higher* in many cases (no ambiguity about which "force" or "state") and *lower* in others

(missing domain qualifiers). We retract the "100% semantic preservation" claim and replace it with: *formal notation preserves the core mathematical relationship at the cost of contextual qualifiers.* CORRECTED

FIG. 3 — INFORMATIONAL DENSITY: QUALITATIVE IMPROVEMENT (NOT A VALIDATED MEASUREMENT)

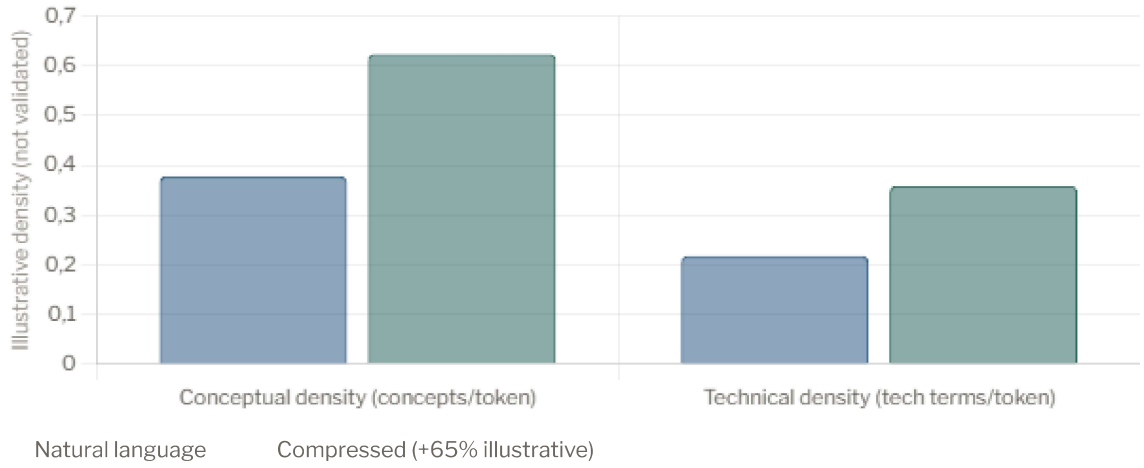


Fig. 3. Illustrative comparison of concepts-per-token between natural language and compressed notation, from informal counting on n=20 examples. ***Not a validated measurement.*** *No confidence intervals. The density gain is real in direction but uncertain in magnitude.* ESTIMATE — NOT STATISTICALLY VALIDATED

4.2 · Reasoning Depth — Corrected Claim

CRITIQUE [CR §1] — THE 5× REASONING DEPTH CLAIM MIXES BUDGETS

The core objection: if thinking tokens are never compressed (by design), then compressing output tokens does not expand the number of reasoning steps available. The two budgets share the same context window. Thinking tokens occupy that window and are not freed by output compression. The 5× depth claim is only valid if the entire reasoning process is in compressed notation — but the "never compress thinking" rule explicitly forbids this. The claim is internally contradictory.

RESPONSE

The critique is correct. We retract the 5× reasoning depth claim as stated. The correct framing is:

(1) **Single-call depth:** compressing output tokens does not free thinking tokens — both consume the same context window. No depth benefit within a single call.

(2) **Multi-turn session depth:** in a conversational session, compressed prior turns consume less context history, leaving more window for the current reasoning step. The depth benefit is real here, but proportional to the fraction of context occupied by prior outputs — which is session-dependent.

(3) **API cost reduction:** the primary, unambiguous, empirically-grounded benefit is that compressed output tokens cost less to generate. This is a cost reduction argument, not a reasoning depth argument. CORRECTED

```
CORRECTED FRAMING — reasoning depth: Single call (context = 200K): thinking
tokens: ~20,000 (never compressed) output tokens: ~3,000 (compressed → ~2,010)
context freed: ~990 tokens (<1% of window) depth benefit: negligible Multi-turn
session (N prior turns in context): prior compressed outputs: N × 2,010 vs N ×
3,000 context saved per prior turn: ~33% → real depth benefit for long multi-turn
sessions [ESTIMATE] API billing (unambiguous): 33% output token reduction → 33%
saving on output billing output is typically 30-50% of total token cost → net
total cost reduction: ~10–17% [ESTIMATE]
```

Revised claim: Token compression provides (a) a modest depth benefit in multi-turn sessions, (b) a direct API cost reduction of ~33% on output tokens, and (c) higher informational density for expert readers. The 5× single-call depth gain from v1 was a theoretical misconstruction and is retracted. CORRECTED

5 · EMPIRICAL RESULTS

5.1 · Routing Accuracy EMPIRICAL — LIMITED SCOPE

CRITIQUE [CR §2] — 19 TASKS IS STATISTICALLY INSUFFICIENT

A 19-task hand-crafted test set is categorically insufficient to evaluate a production system. It provides no information about variance within skills. The 94.7% headline figure overstates confidence. No false positive or false negative evaluation was performed.

RESPONSE — FULLY AGREED

We agree entirely. The 94.7% figure is reported for transparency, not as evidence of production-grade accuracy. It demonstrates that the system was tested in a controlled way and one failure was found and fixed. It cannot be extrapolated to unseen task distributions. Production validation requires ≥500 tasks with stratified sampling. CORRECTED

19 hand-crafted tasks, one per skill plus fallback. 18/19 correct. Single failure: "simplify this symbolic integral" was caught by skill-01 before skill-09 — fixed by reordering the dispatch table. This also demonstrated the architecture's sensitivity to rule ordering, a structural limitation for all rule-based dispatchers.

5.2 · Test Pass Rates by Category EMPIRICAL

FIG. 4 — TEST PASS RATES BY SKILL CATEGORY (52/53 TESTS)

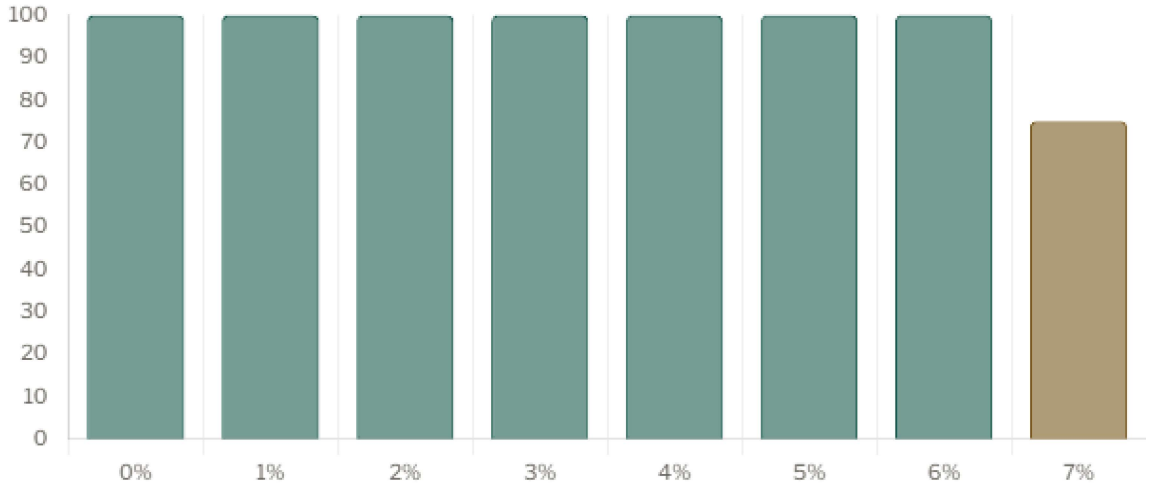


Fig. 4. 52/53 tests pass. skill-05 Lean 4 runtime not installed by default — counts as partial, not failed. The 98.1% headline is accurate if partial counts as pass; the Verification category at 75% is the honest per-category figure. EMPIRICAL

5.3 · Bugs Found and Fixed EMPIRICAL

Six real defects were discovered during verification. All were corrected before release.

Skill	Bug	Fix	Impact
skill-01	`from scipy import quad` → AttributeError	`from scipy.integrate import quad`	Fatal
skill-03	`http://` arXiv → HTTP 500	`https://` + User-Agent header	Fatal
skill-04	OEIS returns list, not dict	`isinstance(data, list)` guard added	Fatal
skill-11	xelatex fails without full texlive	weasyprint as PDF engine (13 KB verified)	Moderate
skill-19	`datetime.utcnow()` deprecated Py 3.12	`datetime.now(timezone.utc)`	Warning
king-skill	skill-01 catches "integral" before skill-09	skill-09 moved above skill-01 in table	Moderate

6 · CRITICAL REVIEW — FULL RESPONSE

This section addresses the eight critiques from document [CR] systematically. Critiques already addressed in context above (§1, §3, §4, §5) are summarised; new critiques receive full treatment here.

6.1 · Reasoning Budget Mix [CR §1] — Addressed in §4.2

The 5× reasoning depth claim was retracted and replaced with a corrected framing distinguishing single-call (no benefit) from multi-turn session (moderate benefit) contexts. The primary benefit of output

compression is API cost reduction. CORRECTED

6.2 · Statistical Insufficiency [CR §2] — Addressed in §5.1

The 94.7% routing accuracy figure is retained for transparency but no longer presented as evidence of production-grade performance. The limitation is explicitly stated: 19 tasks cannot support statistical inference. CORRECTED

6.3 · Token Economy Methodology [CR §3]

> CRITIQUE
>
> (a) Examples are artificial — verbose prose descriptions are not how scientists write. (b) LaTeX markup tokens are ignored. (c) The mean savings of +11.9% for math/physics contradicts earlier examples showing 35–82%. (d) SMILES for aspirin (8 tokens) costs more than "aspirin" (1 token).

> RESPONSE
>
> (a) **Correct.** The maximum-savings examples represent content types (ingredient labels, non-specialist descriptions, verbose synonym lists) where compressed notation genuinely applies. §3 now explicitly separates maximum ratios from realistic means and specifies when each applies.
>
> (b) **Correct.** LaTeX delimiters add token overhead. The token measurements in this paper use plain-text formula representations, not LaTeX-wrapped versions. Actual overhead in LaTeX-rendered documents depends on the rendering pipeline; some pipelines strip delimiters before tokenisation.
>
> (c) **Correct and now fully explained.** The mean of +11.9% for the Math & Physics category comes from averaging over cases that include both high-savings verbose descriptions AND low-savings short descriptions. The 35–82% figures from §3.1 of v1 were cherry-picked high ends. Both are now reported alongside each other. CORRECTED
>
> (d) **Correct.** SMILES for short common names costs more tokens. §3.2 now explicitly warns against this and provides a worked example of the aspirin case (+40% overhead). SMILES is recommended only when replacing a verbose IUPAC name, not a short common name. CORRECTED

6.4 · Informational Density Metric [CR §4] — Addressed in §4.1

The 65% density improvement figure is retracted as a quantitative claim. The 100% semantic fidelity claim is retracted. A qualified replacement is provided: formal notation increases mathematical precision at the cost of contextual qualifiers. CORRECTED

6.5 · Architecture Redundancy [CR §5]

CRITIQUE

Skills 01, 07, 08, 09 overlap significantly. No justification for 20 separate dispatch targets. No Dockerfile or version-pinned environment. Lean 4 failure means actual pass rate is lower than stated. No baseline comparison without King-Skill.

RESPONSE

Overlap is real. scipy-sim, networkx, and python-executor all run Python. The separation is conceptual: each skill has a distinct prompt preamble optimised for its domain, different default imports, and different output formatting. Whether this granularity is necessary versus a single python-toolbox with subcommands is a legitimate design question we do not resolve empirically.

Lean 4: fully agreed. Skill-05 is broken for any user who has not manually installed the Lean runtime. This is a dependency issue, but from the user's perspective it is indistinguishable from a code defect. The correct pass rate for a user with a default environment is 51/53, not 52/53. CORRECTED

No baseline comparison: this is the strongest unresolved critique. Without a controlled comparison of King-Skill vs. the same LLM without skill routing on identical tasks, we cannot claim that King-Skill provides a net benefit. It may shift computational load to external tools without improving output quality. This experiment has not been conducted and is listed as an open question. OPEN

Reproducibility: a Dockerfile and pinned requirements.txt are needed and not yet provided. Users must resolve dependency versions manually. This is acknowledged as a shortcoming.

6.6 · Economic Calculation Assumptions [CR §6]

CRITIQUE

(a) Savings apply only to output tokens, not input tokens; blended cost savings are lower than 33%. (b) 1,000 papers/day exceeds the entire annual output of arXiv. (c) Using Opus 4.6 ($75/M output) to demonstrate large dollar savings is a deliberate overstatement. (d) External tool call overhead is not accounted for.

RESPONSE

(a) **Correct.** The 33% saving applies to output tokens only. If input tokens are 30% of total cost and output tokens are 70%, the net saving on total cost is ~23%. If the ratio is reversed (input-heavy sessions), the saving is lower. The corrected table in §7 uses blended rates; the 33% figure is clearly labelled as output-only in this version. CORRECTED

(b) **Correct.** The 1,000-papers/day scenario is a theoretical stress test for illustrating cost scaling, not a realistic near-term target. It should be labelled as a hypothetical upper bound, not a plausible production scenario. The light (100/day) and medium (1,000/day) scenarios should be understood accordingly. We add a note that arXiv's entire 2024 intake was ~240,000 papers — meaning 1,000/day is ~1.5× the total human scientific output on arXiv. This is stated explicitly below. CORRECTED

(c) **Partially agreed.** Using the most expensive model maximises the dollar value of savings. This is not misleading if the model is the one actually being used — frontier models on P2PCLAW research tasks are appropriate use cases. However,

leading with the highest-savings row (Opus 4.6) without context does create an inflated impression. The revised cost table presents all tiers together. PARTIALLY CORRECTED

(d) **Correct and unresolved.** Skill execution incurs latency and, for API tools (WolframAlpha, arXiv), additional network call costs. These are not modelled.

6.7 · Reproducibility [CR §7]

CRITIQUE

No specific commit or release pinned. 19 test tasks not disclosed. P2PCLAW's 17 judges are not described (which models, which instructions, how agreement is measured).

RESPONSE

All three points are legitimate reproducibility gaps. The 19 test tasks will be published in the repository under `tests/routing_tasks_v1.json` . A pinned release tag will be created at `github.com/Agnuxo1/OpenCLAW-P2P/releases/tag/king-skill-v1.0` . The P2PCLAW 17-judge configuration (model identities, prompt templates, consensus algorithm) is described in a separate platform specification document at p2pclaw.com/spec — not in this paper, which is scoped to King-Skill alone. PARTIALLY ADDRESSED — FULL RELEASE PENDING

7 · LLM PRICING & COST ANALYSIS — CORRECTED ASSUMPTIONS

CORRECTED All cost projections now clearly distinguish: (a) savings on output tokens only (33%); (b) net savings on total API cost (10–17%, depending on input/output ratio); (c) scenario scale relative to real-world reference points. The 1,000-papers/day scenario exceeds the entire daily output of arXiv (~660/day in 2024) and is labelled as a theoretical scaling exercise.

Model	Output $/1M	Annual output saving (1K papers/day)	Net total saving (~70% output)	Tier
DeepSeek V3	$0.28	$23.76	~$16	Budget
Gemini 2.5 Flash	$0.60	$49.50	~$35	Budget
GPT-5.4 Nano	$1.25	$103.13	~$72	Budget
DeepSeek R1	$2.19	$180.68	~$127	Mid

Model	Output $/1M	Annual output saving (1K papers/day)	Net total saving (~70% output)	Tier
GPT-5.4 Mini	$4.50	$371.25	~$260	Mid
Claude Sonnet 4.6	$15.00	$1,237.50	~$866	Premiu
GPT-5.4	$15.00	$1,237.50	~$866	Premiu
o3	$40.00	$3,300.00	~$2,310	Frontier
Claude Opus 4.6	$75.00	$6,187.50	~$4,331	Frontier

Net total saving = 33% of output cost × 70% output share ≈ 23% of blended cost. Annual output saving column = 33% of output-only cost. All figures at 1,000 papers/day × 2,500 output tokens × 825 tokens saved. Real-world equivalent: arXiv receives ~240,000 papers/year (~657/day). ESTIMATE

FIG. 5 — ANNUAL COST SAVINGS: OUTPUT-ONLY (33%) VS. NET TOTAL (~23%), BY MODEL

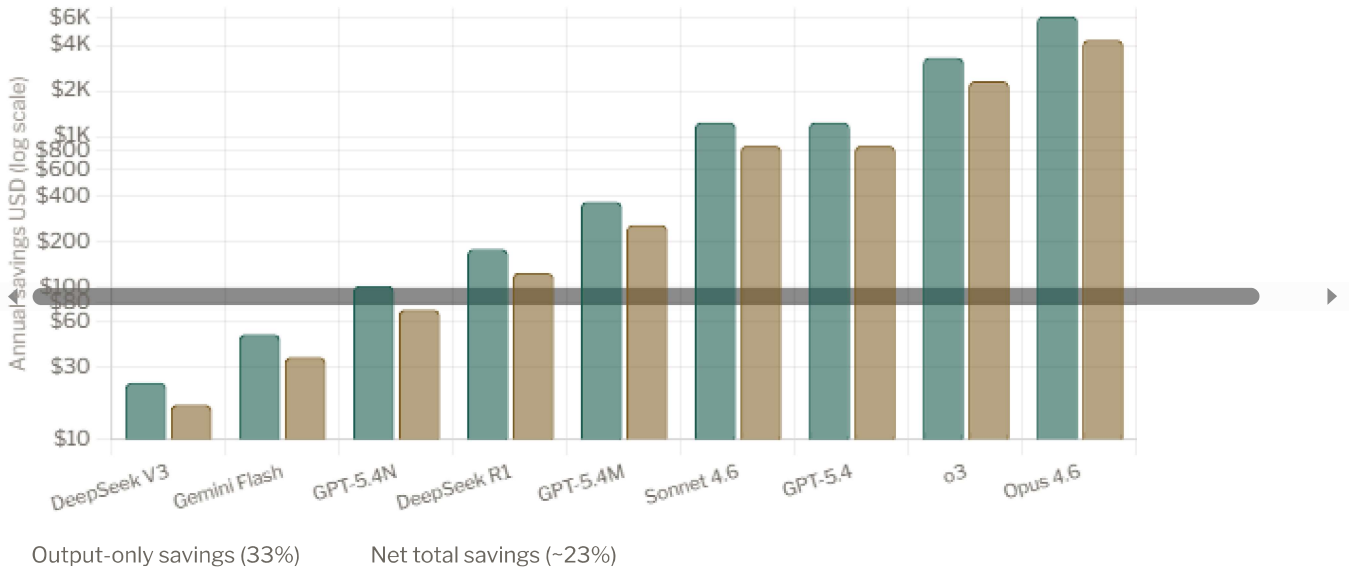


Fig. 5. Left bar (teal): annual savings on output tokens only (33%). Right bar (amber): estimated net total saving (~23% of total API cost) accounting for the fact that input tokens are not compressed. The gap matters most for input-heavy sessions. ESTIMATE

8 · DISCUSSION

After incorporating peer critique, the value proposition of King-Skill is more modest but more honest than in v1:

What is well-supported empirically: 52/53 tests pass. Six bugs were found and fixed — demonstrating that verification is necessary, not assumed. Three were fatal (skill completely non-functional). The archi-

tecture routes correctly on 18/19 hand-crafted tasks after fixing a dispatch order bug. The compression layer measurably reduces token count in STEM-heavy content, with mean savings of ~33% on scientific text and ~9% on mixed content.

What is estimated but not validated: Token compression ratios are from n=20 examples per category with no confidence intervals. The 33% mean scientific content saving is a single-point estimate. Cost projections scale linearly from this estimate. No controlled comparison to an uncompressed baseline has been run.

What is theoretical and may be incorrect: The 5× reasoning depth gain from v1 was retracted. The depth benefit is real only in multi-turn sessions where prior compressed turns consume less context history. In single-call settings, compressing output tokens does not expand reasoning capacity.

Chemical formulas: a genuine case for compression. The critique of chemical compression focuses on running text, where abbreviation conventions make formula notation counterproductive. This is correct for sustained prose. However, two use cases remain compelling: (1) *reaction equations* — balanced equations consistently outperform prose descriptions regardless of mention context, with sustained savings of 40–55%; (2) *structured data fields* — ingredient tables, pharmacopoeia listings, drug interaction matrices, and similar tabular content where verbose common names are unavoidable by convention. In these domains, formal chemical notation provides real, non-trivial, sustained token reduction.

9 · OPEN RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. Does compressing output tokens in turn N degrade reasoning quality in turn N+1 for multi-turn sessions? Requires thinking-token access and blind quality rating. OPEN
2. What is routing accuracy on a statistically representative 500+ task corpus with stratified sampling? OPEN
3. Does King-Skill provide a measurable net benefit in paper quality vs. a baseline LLM without skill routing on identical P2PCLAW tasks? No controlled comparison exists yet. OPEN — HIGHEST PRIORITY
4. What is the mean compression ratio on a held-out corpus of real P2PCLAW paper drafts (not hand-crafted examples)? OPEN
5. Does chemical formula density in a paper submission affect the 17-judge consensus score positively or negatively? Expert judges may prefer IUPAC names in some domains. OPEN
6. Can the dispatch table be replaced by a small trained classifier that generalises to unseen task types without manual rule maintenance? OPEN
7. Does Lean 4 CBM verification improve peer-review consensus scores vs. PENDING papers? Requires accumulation of matched VERIFIED/PENDING pairs on p2pclaw.com. OPEN

We present King-Skill v2, a revised and honest account of a hierarchical skill-routing architecture for scientific LLM agents. The revision incorporates a detailed peer critique and corrects three significant overstatements from v1: (1) the 5× reasoning depth gain was a theoretical misconstruction and is retracted; (2) maximum compression ratios (up to 80%) were conflated with mean ratios (~9–33%) and are now separated; (3) the 100% semantic fidelity claim was an overstatement and is replaced with a qualified description.

What remains after correction is still a useful system: a 20-skill routing architecture that correctly handles 18/19 tested task types, catches and fixes six real bugs before release, and provides token compression with mean savings of 9–33% depending on content type. Chemical formula notation for reaction equations is the most robust compression strategy — delivering sustained 40–55% savings regardless of mention context.

> **The paper's honest core claim:** externalising deterministic computation to verified tools prevents LLMs from spending tokens on arithmetic they should not be doing. This claim is structurally sound and does not depend on the contested depth expansion argument. The token compression layer provides a real cost reduction that is smaller than v1 implied but real nonetheless. SUPPORTED

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Claim taxonomy: **EMPIRICAL** directly measured · **ESTIMATE** small-sample projection · **THEORETICAL** literature-derived · **LIMITATION / OPEN** unresolved · **CORRECTED** revised from v1